

Topic: *In some countries, some high school leavers are choosing to work or travel for a period of time before going to university. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of those school leavers' decision. Give your own opinion.*

After graduating from high school, some students tend to get a job or go on a trip for some time before university life. While I accept that there are **benefits and** drawbacks of this decision, I would argue that it is better to take a gap year to work or travel.

Comment [J1]: not needed because your opinion is that it is better (i.e. has benefits)

The option to get a job or travel straight after school is disadvantageous to some extent. The main shortcoming is that a number of graduating **students** may start their professional careers later than their fellows who do not choose to get a job or go on a trip after high school. As a result, **they** will get promoted **later**. In addition, traveling costs **them** a great deal. If **they** travel right after high school, they **will earn no money** and have to ask their parents for **the expense**. **It** is not advisable that people should take this option.

Comment [J2]: who choose this option

Comment [J3]: these students could/might

Comment [J4]: in their careers

Comment [J5]: not needed

Comment [J6]: students

Comment [J7]: may not earn enough money

Comment [J8]: financial help

Comment [J9]: Therefore,

On the other hand, it seems to me that high school seniors should choose to work or travel for a period of time because of some undeniable advantages. Firstly, working and traveling are both good chances for them to gain some valuable experience. My brother, for instance, travelled to London during his gap year. **By spending time in London, he was able to hear, speak, read and write the English language constantly which gave him countless opportunities to improve his English skills.** Secondly, taking a year out helps young graduates clarify their study and career future. **They** can do various jobs without long-term commitment **in this time**, and discover what might be right for **them**.

Comment [J10]: Very good example

Comment [J11]: In other words...

Comment [J12]: not needed

Comment [J13]: in terms of a future career path.

In conclusion, I believe that there are many advantages for young people who start working or traveling prior to beginning their university studies, although this decision has some notable disadvantages.

Bach, another very well-written essay with a wide of language and complex structures.

It's a pleasure to read your writing! I've made a few suggestions which would help this essay but to be honest it doesn't really need it as it's such a good answer.

Well done. Here are your IELTS scores:

IELTS Marking Criteria	My comments	Band score
Task Response	This essay is long enough – 294 words. The introduction is good, and you give an opinion which relates directly to the question. Your points are all relevant and well supported with examples and explanations. I have added some comments just to make your explanations	8.0

	clearer. Your conclusion rounds the essay off effectively.	
Cohesion and coherence	There is a clear progression of the essay and ideas are arranged coherently – it's easy to read and follow your message. The essay is well balanced in that you discuss both sides equally. You use a variety of simple and complex linkers accurately and appropriately. Paragraphs are very well constructed.	8.5
Lexical resource	Wide range use with some flexibility. Only minor inappropriacies (see my comments/suggestions which add to your writing rather than correct it).	8.0~8.5
Grammatical range and accuracy	Range of structures used accurately and appropriately. No errors detected.	8.0

Overall = a clear band 8.0 (could be 8.5 in parts).